

04-docker-realtime.md

Big Picture (MOST IMPORTANT)

Dockerfile = Recipe 

Image = Packed food box 

Container = Eating the food 

 You:

1. Write recipe (Dockerfile)
 2. Cook & pack it (docker build → image)
 3. Eat/run it (docker run → container)
-

Step 1 — Basic Dockerfile (ELI5)

FROM ubuntu

RUN touch mustafa.txt

 Think like this:

FROM → Which kitchen? (Ubuntu kitchen)

RUN → What to cook? (create file)

 Result:

- Image has `mustafa.txt`
 - When you run → container has that file
-

Step 2 — COPY

COPY aws.txt aws.txt

 Real-world:

COPY = Put your local file into lunch box

 You must have file in your laptop first

Step 3 — ADD

ADD devops.pdf devops.pdf

Real-world:

ADD = COPY + extra power

👉 It can:

- copy local file 
 - download from URL 
 - extract zip/tar automatically 
-

Easy rule:

Use COPY always

Use ADD only if you need URL or auto-extract

Step 4 — ADD from URL

ADD https://...tomcat.zip .

Real-world:

ADD = download file from internet into your box

👉 Inside container → file will be there

Step 5 — WORKDIR

WORKDIR /mustafa

RUN touch harish.txt

Real-world:

WORKDIR = Change working folder

👉 Like:

cd /mustafa

touch harish.txt

Step 6 — RUN vs CMD (VERY IMPORTANT)

RUN

RUN yum install git -y

Real-world:

RUN = cook during preparation

👉 Happens during `docker build`

CMD

CMD yum install maven -y

Real-world:

CMD = what happens when you open the box

👉 Happens during `docker run`

Easy memory trick:

RUN → build time

CMD → run time

Important rule

Multiple RUN → OK

Multiple CMD → only last one works

Step 7 — ENTRYPOINT

ENTRYPOINT ["yum", "install", "git", "-y"]

Real-world:

ENTRYPOINT = fixed behavior (cannot change easily)

CMD = default behavior (can override)

Difference (simple)

Type	Can override?	Meaning
CMD	YES	default action

Type	Can override?	Meaning
ENTRYPOINT	NO	forced action

Example:

docker run image tree

👉 If CMD → replaced

👉 If ENTRYPOINT → added to command

Step 8 — ENV vs ARG

ARG

ARG cloud=aws

Real-world:

ARG = temporary variable (only while cooking)

👉 Only during build

ENV

ENV course=devops

Real-world:

ENV = permanent label on box

👉 Available inside container

Difference

Feature	ARG	ENV
Available at build	YES	YES
Available at runtime	NO	YES
Can override	YES	harder

Brutal truth (you need this)

You memorized:

commands

But you didn't understand:

lifecycle (build vs run)

👉 That's why confusion came in RUN vs CMD vs ENTRYPOINT



Final cheat sheet (remember this only)

FROM → base OS

RUN → build time work

COPY → copy local files

ADD → copy + download

WORKDIR → change directory

CMD → default run command

ENTRYPOINT → fixed run command

ARG → build variable

ENV → runtime variable



One-line memory trick

Build → RUN, ARG

Run → CMD, ENTRYPOINT, ENV



If you want next level

I can give you:

- real-world Node.js Dockerfile (production ready)
- Docker + NGINX + PM2 setup
- multi-stage builds (important for interviews)

Just say: **“give real project dockerfile”**

ELI5 AND ELI10 AS I GIVEN ABOVE

You're close, but your notes mix steps with concepts. I'll clean it up so you can **remember fast under pressure**.



ELI5 (like 5th class)



Big idea

Dockerfile = recipe

Image = food box

Container = eating the food



Step by step

1. FROM

FROM ubuntu



Choose your kitchen

("I will cook in Ubuntu kitchen")

2. RUN

RUN touch mustafa.txt



Cook something and keep it inside box

RUN = do work while cooking (build time)

3. COPY

COPY aws.txt aws.txt



Take file from your laptop → put into box

COPY = copy from your system

4. ADD

ADD devops.pdf devops.pdf



Same as COPY but smarter

ADD = copy + download + unzip

5. WORKDIR

WORKDIR /mustafa

👉 Go into folder

WORKDIR = cd /mustafa

6. CMD

CMD yum install maven -y

👉 What happens when you open the box

CMD = run time command

7. ENTRYPOINT

ENTRYPOINT ["yum","install","git","-y"]

👉 Forced action

ENTRYPOINT = cannot change

CMD = can change

8. ARG vs ENV

ARG cloud=aws

ENV course=devops

👉 Think:

ARG = temporary (only while cooking)

ENV = permanent (stays inside box)

🧠 👤 ELI10 (clear understanding)

🔥 Lifecycle (MOST IMPORTANT)

BUILD TIME → RUN, ARG

RUN TIME → CMD, ENTRYPOINT, ENV

🧩 Your examples explained correctly

Case 1

FROM ubuntu

RUN touch mustafa.txt

👉 When you build:

- file created inside image

👉 When you run:

- file exists
-

Case 2 (COPY)

COPY aws.txt aws.txt

👉 Requires:

- aws.txt must be in your local folder

👉 Result:

- file copied into image
-

Case 3 (ADD)

ADD devops.pdf devops.pdf

👉 Same as COPY + extra features

👉 But don't overuse it

Case 4 (ADD URL)

ADD https://... .

👉 During build:

- file downloaded into image
-

Case 5 (WORKDIR mistake you had)

You wrote:

WOKDIR /mustafa

👉 ❌ Wrong spelling

👉 Correct:

WORKDIR /mustafa

👉 Then:

RUN touch harish.txt

👉 File will be created inside `/mustafa`

Case 6 (RUN vs CMD — you got confused here)

RUN

RUN yum install git -y

👉 Executes during build

👉 Git installed inside image

CMD

CMD yum install maven -y

👉 Does NOT run during build

👉 Runs only when container starts

⚠ Important

Multiple RUN → all run

Multiple CMD → only last works

Case 7 (ENTRYPOINT vs CMD)

You tried:

```
ENTRYPOINT ["yum","install","git","-y"]
```

Then:

```
docker run image tree httpd
```

👉 Result:

ENTRYPOINT always runs
extra args get appended

👉 Final command becomes:

```
yum install git -y tree httpd
```

🔥 Key difference

CMD → default command (can override)

ENTRYPOINT → fixed command (cannot override easily)

Case 8 (ARG vs ENV — you slightly wrong)

You said:

ENV cannot override ❌

👉 Not correct

ARG

ARG cloud=aws

👉 Only during build

Override like:

`docker build --build-arg cloud=azure .`

ENV

ENV course=devops

👉 Available inside container

Override like:

`docker run -e course=aws image`

💣 Where you went wrong (important)

❌ Typos

- `docekr` → `docker`
- `WOKDIR` → `WORKDIR`

👉 These will break builds

❌ Concept confusion

You mixed:

build time vs run time

👉 That's the root of your confusion

Final memory trick (keep this)

FROM → base OS

RUN → build time work

COPY → copy file

ADD → copy + download

WORKDIR → change folder

CMD → default run command

ENTRYPOINT → forced run command

ARG → build variable

ENV → runtime variable

ELI5 (super simple story)

Restaurant example

ENTRYPOINT = restaurant menu (fixed)

CMD = default order (can change)

docker run args = what customer says

Case 1 — CMD (your first example)

FROM centos:centos7

CMD ["yum", "install", "git", "-y"]

What happens?

Run without extra input:

docker run image9

 It runs:

yum install git -y

 installs git

Now you did this:

docker run image9 tree httpd

 Docker says:

User gave new command → replace CMD

👉 Final command becomes:

tree httpd

💥 PROBLEM:

tree command may not exist → fails

🔥 Key idea

CMD = gets completely replaced

🟢 Case 2 — ENTRYPOINT (your second example)

FROM centos:centos7

ENTRYPOINT ["yum", "install", "git", "-y"]

🧠 What happens?

Run:

docker run image9 tree httpd

👉 Docker says:

ENTRYPOINT is fixed → do not replace

Extra args → add to it

👉 Final command becomes:

yum install git -y tree httpd

✓ installs:

- git
 - tree
 - httpd
-

🔥 Key idea

ENTRYPOINT = cannot replace

arguments = added

FINAL COMPARISON (remember this)

Behavior	CMD	ENTRYPOINT
Default run	yes	yes
Override	full replace	no
Extra args	replace	append
Use case	flexible	fixed

One-line memory trick

CMD → replace

ENTRYPOINT → append

Where your understanding was slightly wrong

 You said:

CMD extra values not perform

 Not correct

 It DOES perform — but:

It replaces original command

 You said:

docker build image9 installs git

 Wrong

CMD never runs during build

 Only runs when container starts

BIG mistake in your approach

You used:

```
ENTRYPOINT ["yum", "install", "git", "-y"]
```

👉 This is bad practice

Why?

Every container start → installs packages again

💥 Slow + wrong design

Real-world correct usage

✅ Good example

```
FROM centos:centos7
```

```
RUN yum install git -y
```

```
CMD ["bash"]
```

👉 Install at build time, not run time

✅ Best pattern

```
ENTRYPOINT ["npm"]
```

```
CMD ["start"]
```

👉 Runs:

```
npm start
```

👉 Override:

```
docker run app run dev
```

👉 Runs:

```
npm run dev
```
